

SURGICAL

# Tooth Extractions

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## BEFORE YOUR APPOINTMENT

- Eat beforehand unless you've been told otherwise or are being sedated.
- Arrange a ride home if you're receiving sedation.
- Let us know about blood thinners or any bleeding disorder well before your appointment.

## AFTER YOUR TREATMENT

### Control Bleeding

Bite firmly on the gauze pad for 45–60 minutes. If bleeding continues, replace with fresh moistened gauze — a damp tea bag also works well.

### Protect the Clot

Do not spit, rinse vigorously, smoke, or use a straw for the first 24 hours. Dislodging the clot causes dry socket, which is painful and delays healing.

### Swelling & Comfort

Cold pack 20 minutes on, 20 off, for the first 24 hours. Take pain medication before the anesthetic wears off.

### Eating

Soft, cool foods for the first day. Avoid hot liquids and chewing near the site. Return to a normal diet as comfort allows.

### Rinsing

Starting the day after, rinse gently with warm salt water several times daily, especially after meals.

### Healing Notes

Sharp edges you feel may be small bone fragments working out — this is normal. Dissolving sutures typically disappear within three to five days.

### Call Us If

Bleeding is heavy after several hours, you develop worsening pain around day three (possible dry socket), or you have fever or swelling that increases.